

art exhibition

Colourful League

MUMBAI From being interested in drawing and painting since early childhood, Aditya Basak, 55, has journeyed far and wide to become a creative spirit, who is ever eager to explore new themes and media, despite his considerable experience. A product of the College of Arts and Crafts, Kolkata, Basak is a sensitive artist whose works are considered, by experts, both appealing and intelligent. In his current exhibition, *Amber Alleys, Staccato Sounds*, he draws inspiration from the print and block makers who lived around his house in the by-lanes of north Kolkata. "It was a time when there was no television, and books were the only means to know the world around us," says Basak.

The series is a tribute to the exquisite craftsmanship of the printmakers that now belong to the obsolete printing houses of the city. The amber alleys are stark reminders of dark lanes that housed these factories, while the staccato sounds

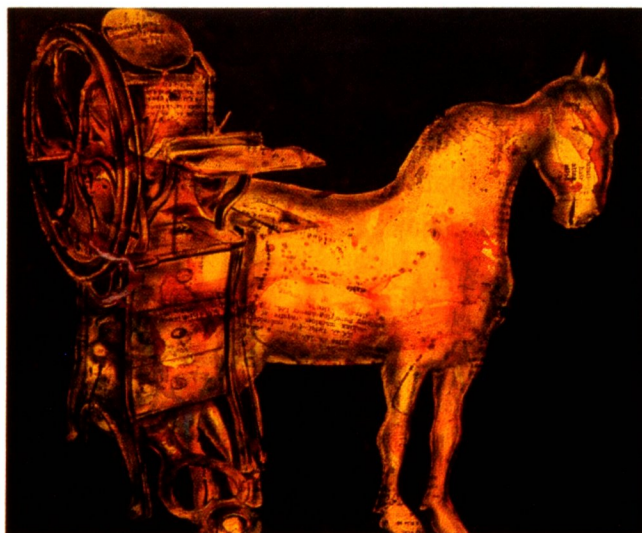
are those that emanate from typewriters and printing stamps. "With the advent of new technology, I have seen the loss of skill, talent and technical efficiency. My paintings try to recreate this painful loss," he says.

An artist who has been working for over two decades, Basak's themes, concerns and creative work have evolved with every exhibition. Reena Lath, owner of Akar Prakar Gallery in Kolkata, says: "Basak is in the league of important contemporaries like Jayashree Chakravarty and Dhruva Mistry who have come out of Bengal."

Dabbling in mixed media, Basak works with a bright palette of colours that are scattered around his canvases. Most of his works are untitled; with paintings identified by numbers assigned to them. Number 13 signifies a giant printing press with a print-maker working beside it. The gloomy light and black walls are offset by the magnificent, bright work that the printmaker creates. At Jehangir Art Gallery from August 1 to 10.

by Swati Mathur

A CREATIVE SPIRIT: Basak's untitled work



festival

Perfect Interaction

CHENNAI If one wants to preserve the charm of classical music, there has to be an active participation from the youth of the time, said shehnai maestro Ustad Bismillah Khan once. Matrka along with the Youth Association for Classical Music has put together Svanubhava, a festival organised by the students, and for the students. Svanubhava is not just a mere platform for performing arts but also envisages in its ambit several interactive activities such as discussions on music, watching films based on classical musicians and also listening to archival recordings of the legends. "The idea of this festival stemmed from the students finding it difficult to be part of the annual December festival. It is the students who have conceptualised the festival," says vocalist Bombay Jayashree. There will be performances by S. Sowmya (vocalist) and Jayanthi Kumaresh (veena). From August 5 to 7. At Kalakshetra, Tamil Nadu Government Music College and the Music Academy. Be there to be educated and entertained.

by S. Sahaya Ranjit

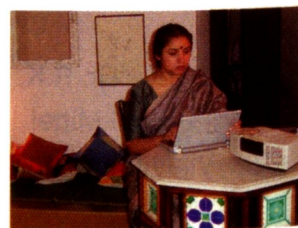
STAR PERFORMER: Jayanthi Kumaresh



theatre

A Solo Stage

HYDERABAD 1, *Madhav Bagh* may sound like an incomplete address without a character. But this is the title of a 40-minute play featuring renowned actor Revathi Menon, on stage, and Arundhati Nag, backstage and put on boards by the Qadir Ali Baig Theatre Foundation. The setting is part of a living room where



ACT WON: Revathi Menon

a middle-aged woman, the mother of three sons, tired of her marriage, brings out vividly the travails of single parenting. At Saptaparni, Banjara Hills, on August 10.

by Amarnath K. Menon